Friedman's article was targeted toward the American reader, for whom any violation of democracy is an offense of the highest order. When Iran and Syria supplied Hezbollah with huge amounts of rockets, their aim was to create deterrence against Israel. They saw Hezbollah as their long arm that would pressure Israel to agree to political compromises and threaten it if it attacked them. The use of these weapons by Hezbollah, in circumstances that did not serve the objectives mentioned above, diminished the capabilities of all three players. In this respect, Nasrallah achieved nothing from this war. Until the war broke out, Hezbollah was sitting on the border and enjoying full freedom of action against Israel. Following the war, Hezbollah was pushed back, far away from the border fence, with a UN force of ten thousand troops positioned as a physical barrier between Hezbollah and the border, and with the IDF having returned to the border. According to Friedman, this was a huge strategic loss for Hezbollah.

In the years leading up to the war, Israel, because of a change in its priorities, degraded and even neglected its ground forces. The Second Lebanon War was a warning signal to Israel, which led the IDF to buckle down and upgrade its ground forces and their level of preparedness. This is another respect in which Israel benefited from the war. Israel's response to the July 12, 2006, incident cost Hezbollah and Lebanon billions of dollars' worth of damage to infrastructure, homes, and roads. In order to rebuild itself, Lebanon had to rely on the charity of the Arab states and Iran. Israel, on the other hand, entered an era of unprecedented economic growth after the war, due in large part to increased foreign investment in its high-tech industry. Friedman concluded his article by saying that if there had been a proper commission of inquiry into Nasrallah's instigation of the war, he would have been forced to resign.

I hope that I have succeeded in providing a picture of the Second Lebanon War and its results that is more balanced and, above all, more reflective of reality.